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Alex Mendelson

Ecologist, Field Biologist, Science Communicator

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Education

MS Biology | California State University, Northridge — Expected May 2026

BS Biology (Zoology, Botany, and Ecology) | California State University, Long Beach — 2022

Field Experience

Restoration Intern | Tidal Influence, LLC, Long Beach, CA — 2023

- Conducted vegetation and avian surveys using line transects and quadrats in coastal restoration sites
- Supported environmental compliance monitoring during construction activities
- Assisted in native plant propagation and greenhouse management for restoration projects
- Monitored restoration site water quality
- Maintained and supported trail infrastructure and site access

Restoration Intern | Bolsa Chica Conservancy, Huntington Beach, CA — 2021–2023

- Performed long-term vegetation monitoring and habitat assessments in sensitive coastal wetlands
- Conducted vegetation mapping and patch analysis to support restoration and mitigation planning
- Assisted in endangered plant mitigation efforts, including monitoring and documentation
- Collected field data under variable environmental conditions and maintained accurate field records

Technical Skills

Field & Survey

- Vegetation monitoring (line/area transects, mapping)
- California native plant ID
- Avian surveys (visual & auditory ID)
- Water quality assessment (pH, salinity, DO_2, turbidity)

Compliance Support

- Field data collection and documentation
- Construction-adjacent monitoring
- Habitat assessment and restoration support

Data & Software

- R (statistical analysis)
- Python (automation, data processing)
- ImageJ, Fiji, Ilastik, OpenCV (image analysis)
- Adobe Creative Suite
- MS Excel and Word
- Google Sheets

Professional Service

Tree Canopy Assessment Research Project | US Forest Service, CSUN Urban Forestry — 2026
Fire-affected neighborhoods of Altadena, CA

President | Behavior, Ecology, and Evolution Research Club — 2024–2025
California State University, Northridge

Research and Teaching Experience

Graduate Researcher 2023–present
terHorst Evolutionary Ecology Lab | CSU Northridge

Teaching Associate (instructor of record) 2023–present
Intro biology lab courses (21 sections) | CSU Northridge

Graduate Assistant, Statistics 2025–2025
Adv. analysis of biological data | CSU Northridge

Research Assistant 2021–2023
Pernet Marine Larval Ecology Lab | CSU Long Beach

Presentations

** denotes presenter*

Mendelson, A. A*., C. P. terHorst, 2026. Adaptation to climate change and its indirect effects on rotifer ecology. Southern California Academy of Sciences, Anaheim, CA [**talk**]; CSUNposium, Northridge, CA [**talk**]

Mendelson, A. A*., C. P. terHorst. 2025. The search for indirect ecological effect of evolution in pitcher plant rotifers. Western Society of Naturalists, San Diego, CA [**talk**]

Mendelson, A. A*., C. P. terHorst. 2025. Does response to increased temperature differ among clones of pitcher plant rotifers? Evolution, Athens, GA [**poster**]

Mendelson, A. A*., C. P. terHorst. P. 2024. Different effects of temperature on pitcher plant rotifer clones. Ecological Society of America, Long Beach, CA [**poster**]

Mendelson, A. A*., C. P. terHorst. 2024. Ecological effect of evolution in pitcher plant rotifers as a response to temperature stress. CSUNposium, Northridge, CA [**poster**]

Mendelson, A. A*., K. Nuon, B. Pernet. 2022, 2023. It's all a big mistake: larval errors and the formation of new aggregations of the serpulid annelid *Ficopomatus enigmaticus*. Western Society of Naturalists, Monterey, CA [**talk**]; Southern California Academy of Sciences, Santa Barbara, CA [**talk**]; California Estuarine Research Society, Costa Mesa, CA [**poster**]; Western Society of Naturalists, Oxnard, CA [**poster**]

Publications

Mendelson, A. A., K. Nuon, B. Pernet. (2025). Gregarious and non-gregarious larval settlement in the aggregation-forming annelid *Ficopomatus enigmaticus*. *Biol. Bull.* Online ahead of print.

Invited Talks

What actually happens when your computer "models"? April 2026
Guest lecturer, CSUN Biol 551 (Computer Modeling)

Local butterfly ecology March 2026
Creative Habitat: Ecology Meets Mosaic, Crafted at the Port of LA